
GenAI, writing and philosophical learning

Sebastian De Haro

AI was used to produce a first draft of these slides, based on an outline, detailed instructions, and texts that I supplied to AI Chat. Afterwards, I edited and adapted that draft to produce the final slides.

**Do you use GenAI to study?
How do you use it?**

Go to wooclap.com
Event code: **LHHYCRP**

A starting point: neither enthusiasm nor prohibition

CONTEXT

AI can support learning

Ask for clarification of a difficult definition.

Request alternative examples.

Test whether you can explain an argument.

Use feedback to revise text that you have written.

AI should not replace learning

Do not outsource the reading.

Do not submit AI-generated answers as your own.

Do not use generated text before you can judge its quality and accuracy.

Always acknowledge AI use when applicable.

The central question is whether AI strengthens or replaces your own learning.

AI and mathematics: promise and dependencies

BEYOND WRITING

What may become possible

Systematic comparison of Cayley graphs and state transfer: work such as Krystal Guo's (KdVI) is striking

AI may help discover relations across technical literatures and formulate hypotheses for verification

What must remain visible

Access usually depends on a handful of commercial companies

Advanced subscriptions €100 per month

Generation is not verification, proof, or understanding

Gartenberg et al. (2026): AI in journal papers

They study submissions and peer reviews at the journal Organisation Science.

Five-year period beginning in January 2021.

Measures of writing quality:

- Readability
- Jargon
- Nominalisation
- Passive voice
- Hedging
- Specificity.

Authors examine both manuscripts and reviews.

Their central claim

Current AI tools, combined with incentives, are pushing research towards more, rather than better, writing.

Results: more submissions and lower readability

RESEARCH EVIDENCE

After ChatGPT:

+42%

Submission volume since late 2022

-1.28 SD

Flesch Reading Ease in January 2026
relative to January 2021

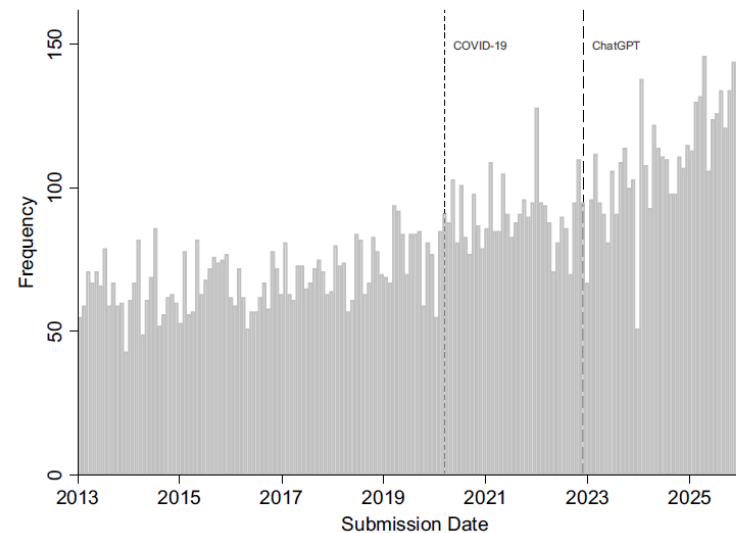
Source: Gartenberg et al. (2026), summary document provided for this class.

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Qualifications

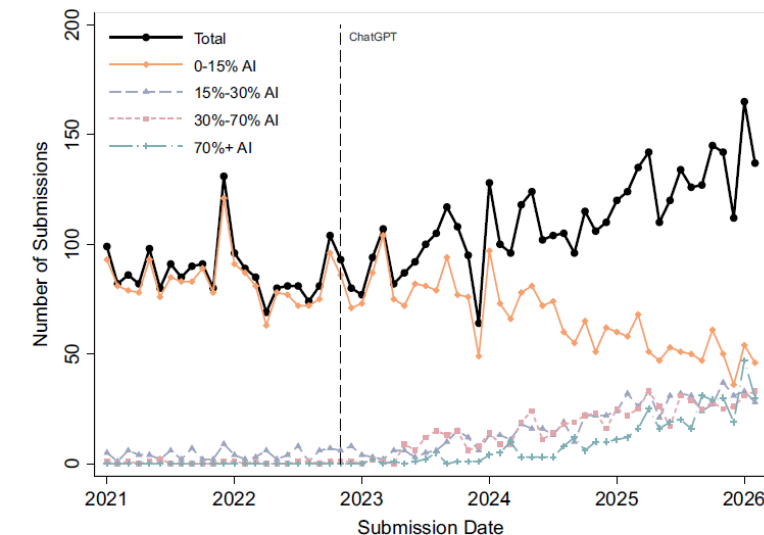
- Systems-level not individual level
- One journal.
- Does not establish that every use of AI makes text worse.

Figure 1. Monthly Submission Volume at *Organization Science* from January 2013 Until the End of 2025



Note. The dashed vertical line marks the launch of ChatGPT in November 2022 and the start of the COVID-19 pandemic in March 2020.

Figure 2. Monthly Submission Volume by AI Use Categories over Time



Notes. Each line shows the share of first submissions' abstracts classified as 0%–15% AI, 15%–30%, 30%–70%, 70%+. The dashed vertical line marks the launch of ChatGPT in November 2022.

Figure 6. Trends in Flesch Reading Ease (Abstracts) from 2013 to February 2026 with Markers for COVID-19 and ChatGPT

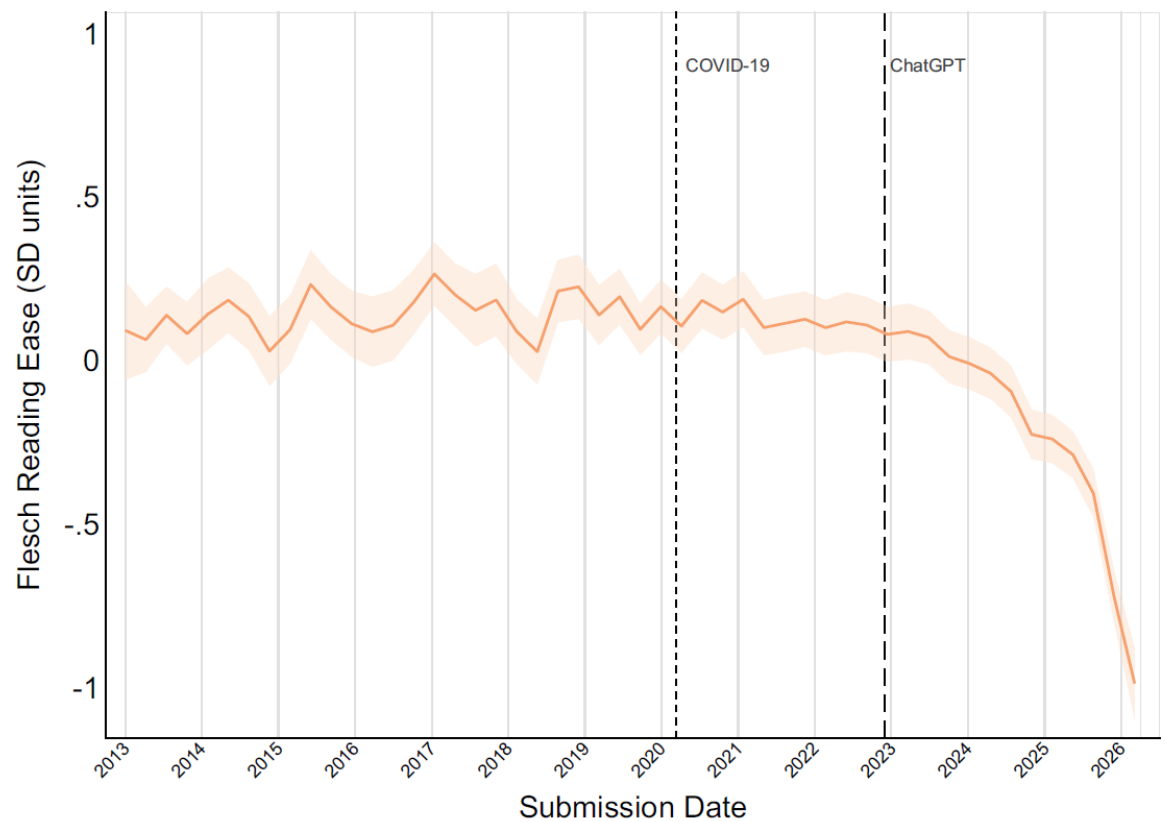
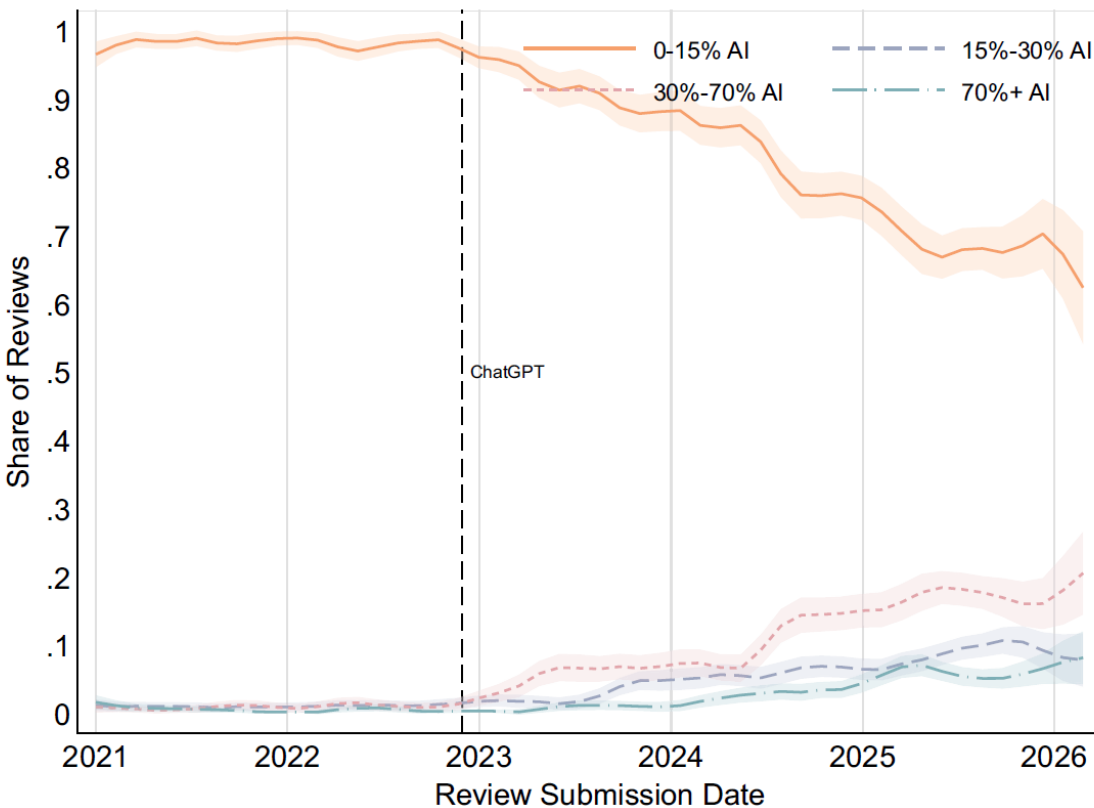


Figure 9. AI Use in Reviews Over Time



Problems in peer review

RESEARCH EVIDENCE

Manuscripts

- Above 30% AI use, desk-rejection rate 30% higher
- High-AI submissions rarely receive revise/resubmit decisions

AI-generated reviews

- > 30% use some AI
- More difficult to read
- Narrow focus

Figure 6. Trends in Flesch Reading Ease (Abstracts) from 2013 to February 2026 with Markers for COVID-19 and ChatGPT

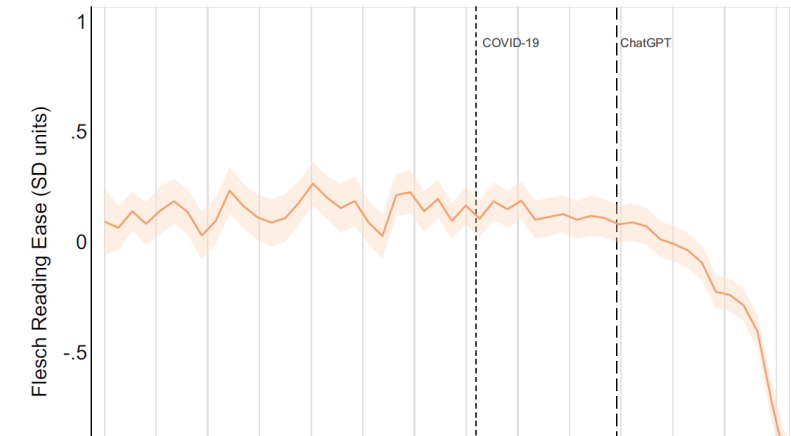
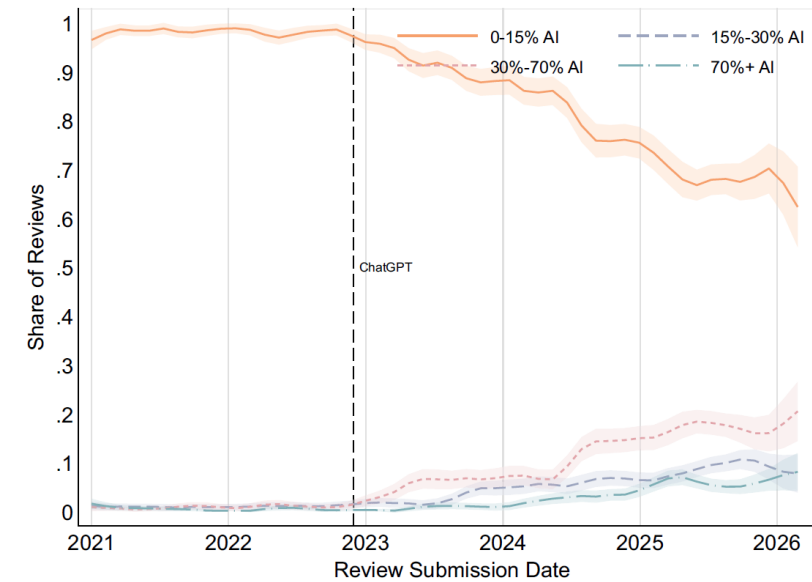


Figure 9. AI Use in Reviews Over Time



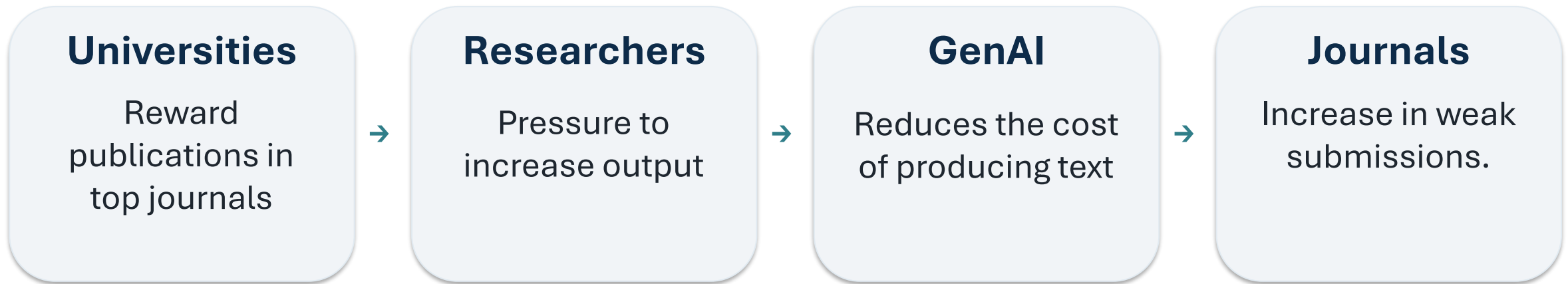
Concern: easy text generation shifts costs to editors and reviewers

Source: Gartenberg et al. (2026), summary document provided for this class.

Why “more rather than better”?

RESEARCH EVIDENCE

Authors’ institutional diagnosis:



Source: Gartenberg et al. (2026), summary document provided for this class.

Dutch example: Prime Minister Rob Jetten's posts on social media

What NRC reports

- 232 posts by Prime Minister and his party reported to have been AI-generated
- Issue became especially sensitive where posts concerned apologies to Moluccan community
- Public debate focussed on authenticity and responsibility

AI-gebruik van premier Jetten op social media ligt onder de loep

Premier Jetten doet luchtig over zijn AI-gebruik voor de 'socials', maar volgens experts dreigt afbreuk van het imago en authenticiteit voor politici die dit doen.

Denise Retera

DEN HAAG

In 2018 zegt Rob Jetten - dan net fractievoorzitter van D66 in de Tweede Kamer - voor de draaiende televisiecamera's drie keer achter elkaar exact dezelfde zinnen over de afschaffing van de dividendbelasting. Doordat zijn gezichtsuitdrukking ook exact hetzelfde blijft, doet hij denken aan een vastgelopen robot. Het levert hem de bijnaam 'Robot Jetten' op.

Pas een paar jaar later heeft Jet-



Pangram detection has become very good.

Source: Denise Retera, "AI-gebruik van premier Jetten op social media ligt onder de loep", NRC, 11 September 2026.

Example: writing a philosophical review paper with AI

Starting point: an outline for a review paper i.e. not new research

I have given you the outline of the Chapter for the Elsevier reference work where I am writing a Chapter on Scientific Theories together with Hans Halvorson. Next to each section is the number of words it needs to have.

Here below I give you the latex format that I will use (taken from a previous chapter on Dualities I wrote). Start by writing section 2 on the received view, in latex. Put also the outline I am giving you into the latex, so that I will already have the structure with the outline of the content (everything up to section 6, conclusion: forget the rest, although you can use the references if you have access to them). We will go section by section, and I will show you how to write. I left some references so you can see how to write references.

What the collaboration involved

Human work

Construct detailed outline of the paper and argumentation

Give detailed instructions about style and literature

Endless rewriting and feedback, additional writing

AI assistance

Produce text according to detailed instructions

Rewrite taking detailed feedback into account

The project is a **review paper**: it does not begin by asking AI to generate original philosophical ideas

Expert guidance is needed throughout: prompting, checking, selecting, writing, and rewriting

500 pages of conversation, and the paper is still unfinished

Writing with AI requires expertise

CONTEXT

You can responsibly use AI to help write **only if both conditions** hold:

(A) You are already an expert

You can check claims, detect omissions, and revise to improve the argument

(B) You can already write philosophy

You recognise unnatural text and weak or incomplete arguments

Before that stage, the priority is to *develop your own philosophical voice and judgement.*

Why this matters in Philosophy of Science

COURSE

GenAI is good at surface summaries, but poor at argumentative nuance

This course is about learning to:

- Read and (re)construct arguments carefully
- Evaluate whether they succeed
- Produce and criticise written text by the same standards

AI use in this course: appropriate uses

AI may be used as a study aid when it supports your own study

Clarify

Ask for an explanation of a term after you have tried to understand the text

Compare

Request alternative examples, then assess whether they really fit the concept

Test

Ask AI to question you on an argument you have read

Revise

Request suggestions about a text you have written; decide yourself which suggestions to use

In every case, use AI to deepen your understanding, rather than to replace reading and thinking

AI use in this course: limits and transparency

COURSE POLICY

Not appropriate

- Outsourcing assigned reading
- Generating a text for submission
- Using text that you cannot assess for accuracy, quality, and argumentation

Transparency in written work

- State what you did yourself
- Explain whether and how AI was used, for which purpose, and which choices were your own

Your submitted work must make your own reasoning and responsibility visible

Conclusion

- 1 Use AI to test your understanding
- 2 Develop your own philosophical voice before relying on AI to draft text
- 3 Be transparent about AI use and responsible for every claim you submit